



Photo shows the style reference for the ballerina shoes, not the finished crocheted product.

LME CROCHET PATTERN - BABY

ELLIE'S BALLERINA SHOES

LME BABY COLLECTION - WOODLAND DREAMS

Sweet, classic baby ballerina shoes with a round toe, a little deer face with a bow on the toe, a T-bar strap, a pretty picot edge and a heart embroidered on the sole. Five sizes, from preemie to 12 months, plus a matching hair bow. Crocheted in the same natural colours as the rest of the Ellie collection.

By Renate Dahl

Little Montessori Explorers

lmexplorers.com



TIP: Read through the whole pattern and the size chart on page 4 before you start, and crochet a small swatch to check your gauge.

ABOUT ELLIE'S BALLERINA SHOES

PART OF ELLIE'S WORLD

Ellie's ballerina shoes belong to the LME Baby Collection "Woodland Dreams". Imagine Ellie herself with a little pair of shoes to dance around the flower meadow in, that is exactly the feeling these ballerinas are meant to have: soft, sweet and ready for play.

STYLE

A classic ballerina shoe shape with a round toe and T-bar strap, in the same natural colours as the rest of the collection: cream, powder pink and light brown. Can be mixed and matched, for example cream shoes with a pink bow.

A GOOD FIT

Crocheted tightly, just like the rest of the amigurumi collection, so the shoe holds its shape and sits neatly on the foot without becoming floppy or too big.

MATERIALS AND YARN ALTERNATIVES

YARN

Bystrikk Merino or DROPS Cotton Merino in cream, powder pink or light brown for the shoe itself, plus a small leftover of powder pink for the bow and light brown/cream for the deer face (whichever colour you are not using on the shoe itself). The same yarn family as the rest of the Ellie collection.

Alternative yarn: any soft cotton-blend DK-weight yarn works well, for example DROPS Safran, Hobbii Amigo or Paintbox Simply DK. Cotton is easiest to keep clean.

TOOLS AND SUPPLIES

- Heklenål 3 eller 3,5 mm · avhengig av hvor stramt du hekler
- Stoppenål med butt spiss · til all somming
- Et lite, mykt hekleknapp (se side om T-stropp) · eller en enkel løkkeløsning uten knapp
- Hårspenne eller myk hårstrikk uten metalleder · til den matchende hårsøyfen, valgfritt
- Saks og målebånd

SIZE CHART

Measure the child's foot from heel to big toe, and choose the closest size. If you are between two sizes, choose the larger one, baby feet grow fast.

Size	Approximate age	Foot length
Preemie	preemie/small newborn	approx. 7.5 cm
0 to 3 mo	0 to 3 months	approx. 9 cm
3 to 6 mo	3 to 6 months	approx. 10 cm
6 to 9 mo	6 to 9 months	approx. 11 cm
9 to 12 mo	9 to 12 months	approx. 12 cm

The numbers in the pattern are always given in this order: preemie (0-3) 3-6 (6-9) 9-12 months. Circle the numbers for your size with a pencil before you start.

DIFFICULTY AND GAUGE

DIFFICULTY

Medium. Good practice for crocheting an oval base and shaping a shoe form.

GAUGE

Crochet tightly: approx. 20 sc x 22 rounds = 10 x 10 cm on a 3 to 3.5 mm hook. If you crochet looser, the shoe goes floppy and loses its shape.

ABBREVIATIONS (NORWEGIAN AND US)

The shoes use single crochet and a picot technique for the edge. Here are the abbreviations, with the common US crochet terms alongside.

Norwegian	US	Means
lm	ch	luftmaske / chain
fm	sc	fastmaske / single crochet
kjm	sl st	kjedemaske / slip stitch
picot	picot	liten pigg: 3 lm, kjm tilbake i første av de tre luftmaskene
økn	inc	økning: 2 fm i samme maske. Gir én maske mer.
m	st(s)	maske(r)
()	()	totalt antall masker på omgangen
...	*...*	gjenta det mellom stjernene så mange ganger som står bak

TIPS BEFORE YOU START

- Always crochet a test shoe in the smallest size first, if you are unsure of your gauge.
- Try the shoe gently against the foot (or a drawing of the foot) as you work the upper.
- The two shoes should match exactly, count the stitches carefully on both before moving on to the next part.

HOW THE SHOE IS BUILT

Each shoe has six parts. Crochet everything twice, once for each foot.

1. The sole

oval base, with an embroidered heart

2. The upper

the sides and toe

3. The deer face

a little head with ears on the toe

4. The T-bar strap

with a closure

5. The picot edge

a decorative trim at the top

6. The bow

between the ears on each shoe

PART 1: THE SOLE

The sole is crocheted flat, as an oval, and forms the base for the whole shoe. The numbers are given in the order preemie (0-3) 3-6 (6-9) 9-12 months.

Method: Chain the number of stitches given for your size. Starting in the 2nd chain from the hook: work 1 sc in each chain along one side, work 3 sc in the last chain (the toe tip), continue with 1 sc in each of the remaining chains on the other side, and finish the round with 2 sc in the very first stitch (the heel). You now have a flat, oval base.

Rnd	Description	Sts
1	chain 8 (9) 10 (11) 12, crochet the oval base (see method above)	20 (22) 24 (26) 28
2	inc evenly in both curved ends (approx. 6 increases in each)	32 (34) 36 (38) 40

Do not cut the yarn. You continue straight into the upper from the same thread. Feel free to embroider a small heart in the middle of the underside of the sole in a contrasting colour, as in the reference photo, a sweet detail that shows when the baby lifts their foot.

PART 2: THE UPPER

The upper is crocheted straight up from the outer edge of the sole, in your chosen main colour.

Rnd	Description	Sts
1	sc in each stitch around (same count as the last round of the sole)	32 (34) 36 (38) 40
2 to end	sc straight up with no increases, number of rounds: 3 (3) 4 (4) 5	32 (34) 36 (38) 40

Shape the foot opening: On the last round, only crochet over the back and side two-thirds of the round (the heel and sides), leaving the front third (over the toes) open and unworked. Fasten off, leaving a long tail. Try the shoe on the foot here, and adjust the number of rounds on the second shoe if needed, so both match.

PART 3: THE DEER FACE

A little, flat deer head is sewn onto the toe of each shoe, in a colour that contrasts with the shoe itself.

Rnd	Description	Sts
1	6 sc in a magic ring	6
2	inc x 6	12
3	(1 sc, inc) x 6	18
4	18 sc straight	18

Fasten off, leaving a long tail, and press the head flat. Crochet two tiny ears (5 sc in a magic ring, fasten off, make 2 per shoe) and sew them onto the top of the head, with a bit of the top peeking up over the top edge of the shoe, just like in the reference photo. Embroider a small face (two eyes, a little nose, and pink cheeks if you like) using the same technique as Ellie's other motifs. Sew the deer face securely onto the middle of the toe of the shoe.

PART 4: THE T-BAR STRAP AND CLOSURE

The T-bar strap runs from the middle of the toe opening, up and over the instep, to one side.

Attach the yarn in the middle front of the bottom edge of the opening. Crochet a short strap of single crochet straight over the instep, in a length that suits the size (try it against the foot). Attach the strap to one side of the shoe with a few secure stitches.

CLOSURE, TWO SAFE OPTIONS

- **Without a button (recommended for the smallest sizes):** Let the strap end in a small crocheted loop, and sew the loop directly onto the other side of the shoe. No loose button, safest for the smallest sizes.
- **With a soft crocheted button:** Crochet a small flat "button" (5 sc in a magic ring, fasten off) and sew it securely onto the side of the shoe. Slip the strap's loop over the button. Never use a hard plastic or metal button, and check that the button is firmly attached before every use.

PART 5: THE PICOT EDGE

The picot edge gives the shoe its classic, slightly lace-like ballerina look, and is crocheted last, all the way around the top opening.

Attach the yarn anywhere along the top edge. Crochet *1 sc in the next stitch, 3 ch, sl st back into the first of the three chains (one picot made)*, repeat all the way around the opening. Finish with a slip stitch and fasten the yarn securely on the inside.

PART 6: THE BOW

A small bow is sewn on between the ears, at the top of the deer face on each shoe.

Row	Description	Sts
1	10 ch + 1 turning chain	10
2 to 5	sc in each stitch back across, 4 rows	10

Cut, leaving a long tail. Fold the rectangle together in the middle and wrap a short length of yarn tightly around the waist, so it forms a small bow shape. Sew the bow on between the ears, at the top of the deer face.

THE MATCHING HAIR BOW

The same bow as on the shoes, a little bigger, sewn onto a soft hair clip or hair tie with no metal parts.

Row	Description	Sts
1	14 ch + 1 turning chain	14
2 to 6	sc in each stitch back across, 5 rows	14

Fold and tie together just like the shoe's bow. Sew it securely onto a soft hair clip or hair tie. Remember: hair accessories should always be removed when the child is sleeping or unsupervised.

ASSEMBLY, STEP BY STEP

- 1 Crochet the sole and upper as one piece, for both shoes, and feel free to embroider a heart on each sole.
- 2 Crochet the deer faces with ears and embroider the faces, and sew one onto the toe of each shoe.
- 3 Crochet the T-bar strap on each shoe, and fasten with your chosen closure (no button, or a soft crocheted button).
- 4 Crochet the picot edge around the top of both shoes.
- 5 Crochet two bows and sew them on between the ears on each deer face.
- 6 Fasten every loose end securely on the inside, and trim what is left.
- 7 Try both shoes on the foot one last time, and check they match in size and fit well.

PHOTO GUIDE

Add your own photos of each step here once you have crocheted the shoes yourself.



The finished sole



The upper with the opening



T-bar strap and closure



Finished shoes with a bow

SAFETY AND CARE

SAFETY

- No parts are glued. Everything is sewn on with strong, twisted cotton thread and plenty of tight stitches.
- Never use a hard plastic or metal button on the smallest sizes, choose the button-free loop closure instead.
- Check the shoes regularly for wear: loose threads, a loose deer face, ears, bows or buttons that feel loose. Discard or repair immediately if anything is wrong.
- The shoes are intended for indoor play and cosiness, not as a substitute for soles when walking outdoors.
- This pattern is a guide for home use. If the finished product is sold, it must always be checked, tested and marked as required under current local safety requirements and regulations for children's products.

CARE AND WASHING

Hand wash in lukewarm water with a little mild soap. Gently press out the water in a towel, do not wring. Lay flat to dry, neatly shaped.

CONGRATULATIONS, THE SHOES ARE DONE!

Now you have crocheted a little pair of ballerina shoes for the Ellie collection.
Perfect for photos, gifts and everyday cosiness!

THE REST OF THE LME BABY COLLECTION

- Ellie, the little fawn
- Ellie's pacifier clip
- Ellie's rattle
- Ellie's stroller toy
- Ellie's activity toy

COPYRIGHT

(c) Renate Dahl, Little Montessori Explorers. This pattern is a fully original LME design. You are welcome to sell finished pieces you make from this pattern, on a small personal scale, provided the finished product is checked against current safety requirements. The pattern itself, its text and images, may not be shared, copied or resold.

By Renate Dahl · Little Montessori Explorers · lmexplorers.com